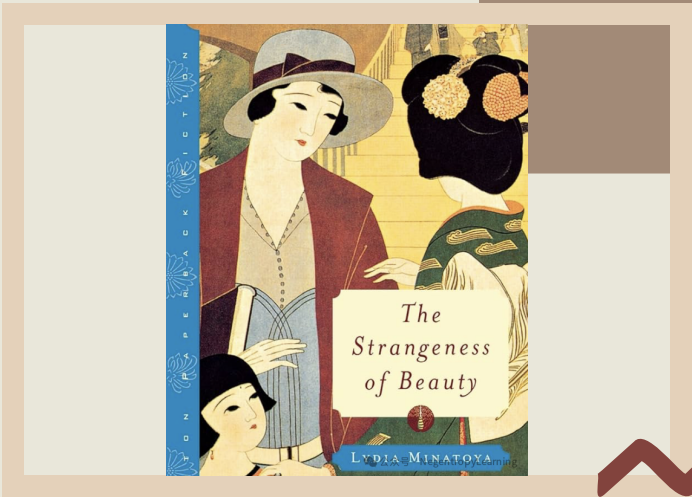


Day 53 真爱至上

绒花儿 NegentropyLearning 2025年12月14日 17:19 四川

Courage

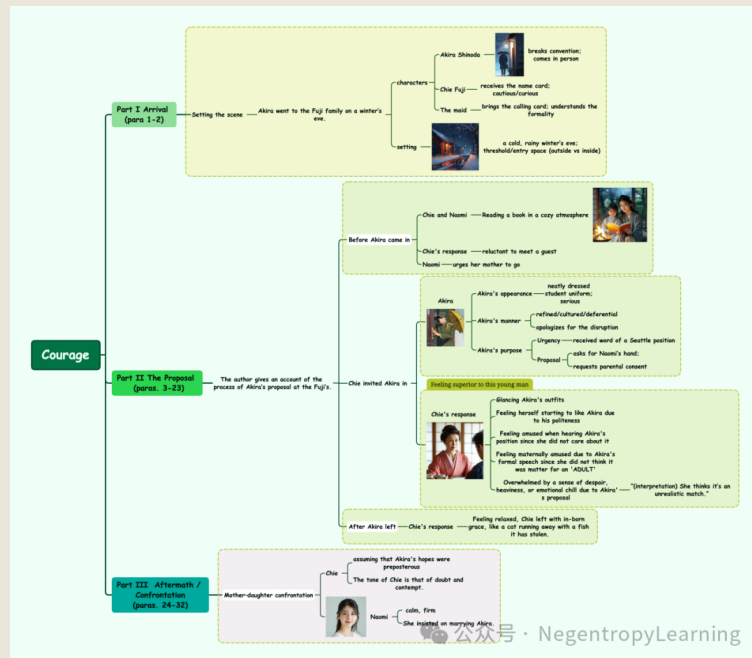
Lydia Minatoya



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ABOUT XIU'S 2025

Mind Mapping



PART ONE



PARAGRAPH ONE

Akira **came** directly, breaking all tradition.

Was that it?

Had he **followed** form—**had** he **asked** his mother to speak to his father to approach a go-between—**would** Chie **have been** more receptive?



WORDS



★ **Form** [n.]: accepted custom; the usual/expected way of doing things; convention. 惯例；常规；礼节；规矩（也可指“形式/表格/形态”，但此处不是）

★ **approach** [v.]: to come near 接近；走近；靠近；| to speak to someone to ask for something, discuss, or make a proposal (formal)（正式）与某人接洽/提出请求/商谈

★ **go-between** [n.]: an intermediary who carries messages or negotiates between two sides; a mediator. 中间人；调停者；媒人

★ **receptive** [adj.]: willing to listen to, accept, or consider new ideas; open and responsive. 乐于接受的；善于接纳的

Grammar

💡 条件句：IF- Clause（条件），Main Clause（结果）

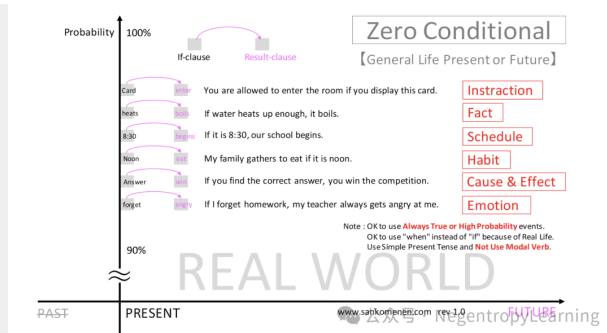


Zero Conditional

Zero Conditional: **If**（一般现在时），主句（一般现在时）

e.g. If you **heat** ice, it **melts**.

📖 客观事实/规律

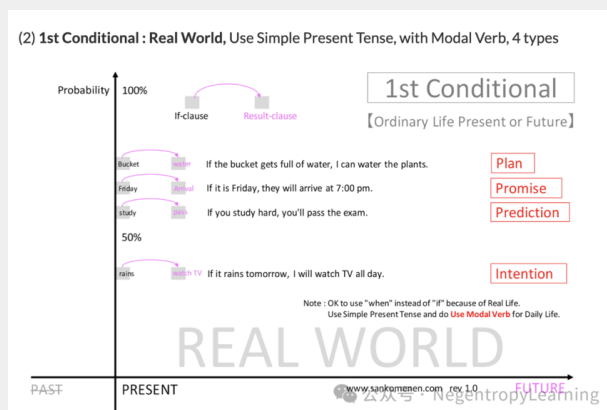


First Conditional

First Conditional: If (一般现在时), 主句 (Will + Verb)

e.g. If you **come**, I **will be** happy.

📖 预测将来很有可能发生的事情



Second Conditional=Future/Present Unreal

3) Second Conditional:

1 If (一般过去时), 主句 (Would/should/could + Verb)

e.g. If I **were** you, I **would try** again.

📖 与现在事实相反(Present Unreal)

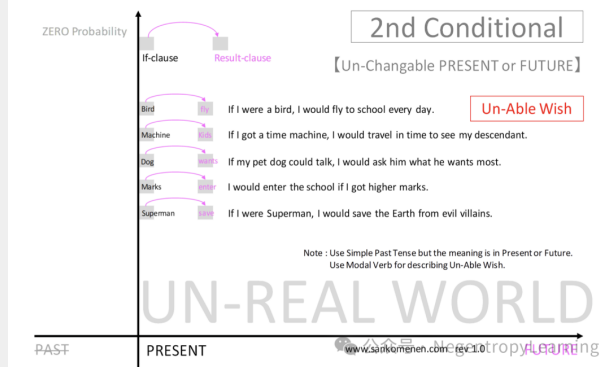
⚠️ 可倒装

结构: Were + S + (adj/n), S + would/could/might + V 原

例:

Were I you, I would try again.

(= If I were you, ...)



2 If ([should do/were to do]) , 主句 (would/should/could + Verb)

e.g. If it **should rain** tomorrow, we **would stay** at home.

If I **were to win** the lottery, I **would travel** the world.

与将来事实相反(Future Unreal)

! 可倒装

结构: Were + S + to do, S + would/could/might + V 原

例:

Were I to win the lottery, I would travel the world.

(= If I were to win..., ...)

对应将来可能性较低/较正式的假设 (future less probable)

结构: Should + S + V 原, S + would/could/might + V 原

例:

Should it rain tomorrow, we would stay at home.

(= If it should rain tomorrow, ...)

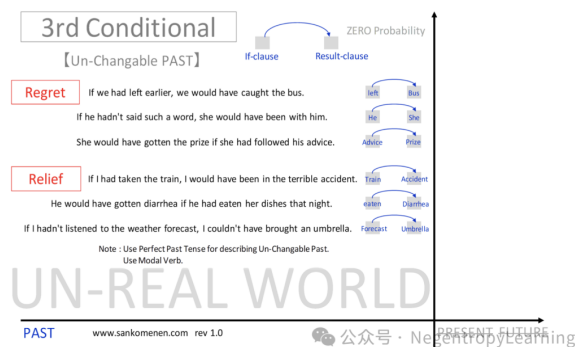
Third Conditional=Past Unreal

4) Third Conditional:

If (过去完成时), 主句 (would/should/could+ have done)

e.g. If he **had studied**, he **would have passed** the exam.

与过去事实相反(Past Unreal)



! 可倒装

结构: Had + S + done, S + would/could/might/should + have done

例：

Had he studied harder, he would have passed the exam.
(= If he had studied harder, ...)

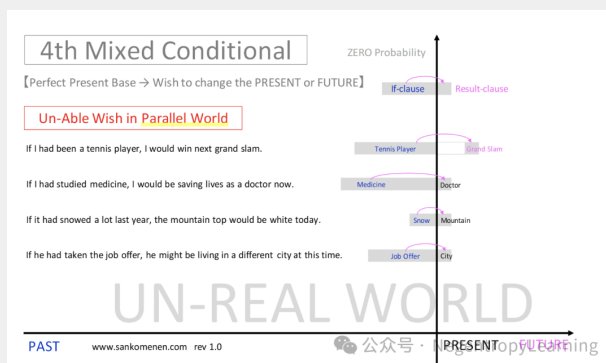
Mixed Conditional

5) 过去条件 → 现在结果

If + had done (过去完成), would/could/might + V原 (现在结果)

e.g. If I **had studied** harder, I **would be** more confident now.

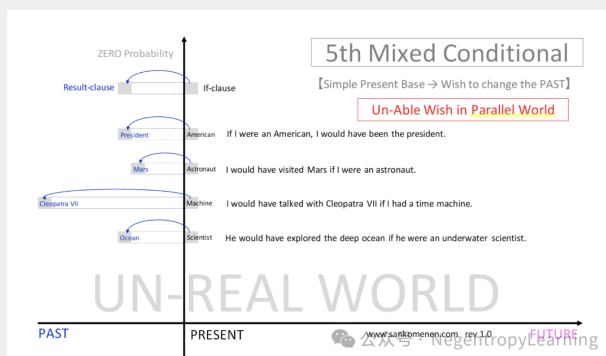
含义：过去没更努力 → 现在不够自信。



6) 较少见：现在条件 → 过去结果

If + 过去式 (表示现在不真实/性格状态), would/could/might + have done (过去结果)

e.g. If he **weren't** so stubborn, they **might have ended up** being friends.



💡 虚拟语气 Subjunctive Mood 的句法结构：时态形式回退 (backshifting) 是虚拟语气的核心

Mood

1) Indicative mood (陈述语气)

功能：陈述事实、提问真实信息、描述“认为是真的/可能是真的”。

2) Imperative mood (祈使语气)

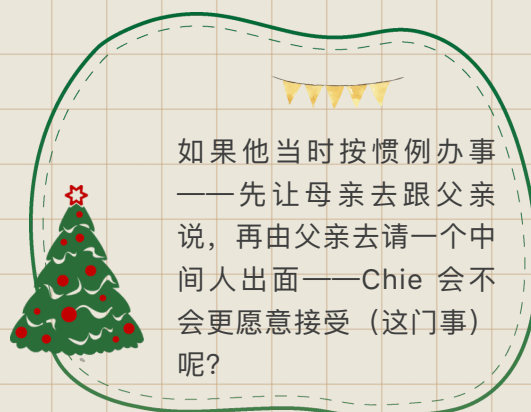
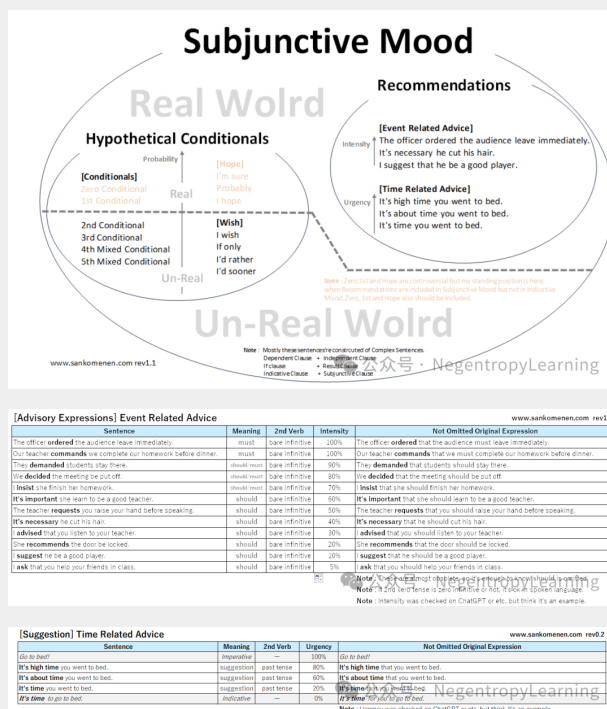
功能：命令、请求、建议 (直接对对方发指令)，常省略主语 you。

3) Subjunctive mood (虚拟/非陈述语气)

功能：表达非事实性内容；假设、愿望、建议/要求、必要性等。

A) Unreal / Hypothetical (反事实/假设类：靠 backshifting) —— 依靠 backshifting: were / had done) 。

B) Mandative subjunctive (建议/要求/必要性：that 从句用原形) —— 不依靠回退，靠动词原形，事件本身可以很真实、很可能发生。



PARAGRAPH TWO

He **came** on a winter's eve.



WORDS



★ **Eve [n.]**: 前夕 / 前一天晚上 (the day or night before)

! on the eve of + 名词: 在.....前夕

但在 “He came on a winter's eve.” 里, eve 更常见、最贴合的是 “evening (傍晚/夜晚)”, 相当于 on a winter evening.

He **pounded** on the door [主句1]

while a cold rain **beat** on the shuttered veranda, [时间状语从句]

so at first Chie **thought** him only the wind. [主句2]



WORDS



★ **Pound** [v.]: to hit repeatedly and hard; to bang. 猛击; 猛敲; 连续重击

★ **shutter** [v.]: to close or cover with shutters; to install shutters 给.....装百叶窗/窗板; (用百叶窗/窗板) 关上、遮住

★ **veranda** [n.]: a roofed platform along the outside of a house; a porch 门廊; 走廊; (带顶的) 外廊/阳台



The maid **knew** better.



WORDS



★ **maid** [n.]: a female domestic worker; in a hotel, someone who cleans rooms. 女佣; 女仆; (酒店) 客房服务员 a young unmarried woman (old-fashioned) 小姐/未婚女子 (较旧式、文艺或历史语境)

💡 maid of honor/bridesmaid (伴娘/首席伴娘)

💡 bride 新娘

💡 groom 新郎

💡 groomsman/best man 伴郎

Chie **heard** her soft scuttling footsteps, the creak of the door.



WORDS



★ **scuttling [adj.]**: moving quickly with short, light steps; 急匆匆的小步快走；窸窸窣窣地移动（常带“轻、快、偷偷”的感觉）

[SYN] scurry

💡 Scuttle 的动机是“躲避”：核心是为了避开注意、危险，或因为负担而行动不便。因此给人的感觉是鬼祟、笨拙、沉重、惊慌。

Scurry 的动机是“抵达/处理”：核心是为了尽快到达某处或处理某事。因此给人的感觉是轻快、忙碌、紧张、高效。

★ **creak [n/v.]**: a harsh squeaking sound 吱呀声/嘎吱声（门、地板、楼梯、旧床）

! 这里的 creak/scuttle 都是 Onomatopoeia 的用法

*Then the maid **brought** a calling card to the drawing room, for Chie.*



WORDS



★ **a calling card [n.]**: a small card with a person's name used for social visits (old-fashioned); a business card 名片；（旧时）来访名片（拜访时留下的卡片）| a distinctive feature or sign of something 标志；特点；“一眼认出的特征”（比喻义）

! 特点：

feature/trait/characteristic/hallmark/signature/giveaway/tell-tale sign

★ **drawing room [n.]**: a formal room in a large house where guests are received (old-fashioned/BrE) 客厅；会客厅（偏旧式/英式，强调“接待客人”的正式空间）

! drawing room 原本来自 withdrawing room（撤到里间休息/私下聊天的房间），后来缩成 drawing room，所以它自带“更正式、更体面”的气质。

PART TWO

PARAGRAPH Three

Chie **was** reluctant to go to her guest; perhaps she **was feeling** too cozy.

WORDS

★ **cozy [adj.]**: warm, comfortable, and safe 温暖舒适的；惬意的 | friendly and close 亲密的；关系融洽的 | too friendly in a way that seems improper, secretive, or suspicious. “不太正当/暧昧/勾结”义（带批评）

She and Naomi **were reading** at a low table set atop a charcoal brazier.

WORDS

★ **atop** [prep.]: on top of; upon 在.....顶上；在.....之上（比 on top of 更简洁、偏书面）

★ **charcoal** [n.]: black carbon made from wood (fuel); also a drawing material. 木炭；（绘画）炭笔/木炭条；炭画（材料或作品）

★ **brazier** [n.]: a container for holding burning coals (for warmth/cooking). 火盆；炭盆（常为金属器皿，用木炭取暖或烹饪）



A thick quilt **spread** over the sides of the table
so their legs **were tucked** inside with the heat.



WORDS



★ **quilt** [n.]: a thick warm bedcover, often stitched; sometimes made from pieces of cloth 被子；棉被；（拼布）被

★ **tuck** [v.]: to put something in a secure or cozy position; to fold/press it in 把.....塞进/掖好，使整齐、保暖

PARAGRAPH FOUR

"Who **is** it at this hour, in this weather?"
Chie **questioned** [主句1]
as she **picked** the name card off the maid's lacquer
tray. [时间状语从句]

WORDS

★ **lacquer [n.]**: a shiny protective coating; 漆; 清漆/亮光漆 (涂层); (口语) 发胶/定型喷雾 (hair lacquer)

★ **tray [n.]**: 托盘; 盘 a flat container for carrying/holding things.

PARAGRAPH FIVE

"Shinoda, Akira. Kobe Dental College,"
she **read**. [para.5]

WORDS

★ **dental [adj.]**: 牙科的; 牙齿的 relating to teeth or dentistry.

PARAGRAPH SIX

Naomi **recognized** the name.

Chie **heard** a soft intake of air.

WORDS

★ **Intake [n.]**: the amount taken into the body 摄入量（最常见） | an intake of air / breath 吸气；吸入（吸一口气） | 招收人数；招生；一届新生（新入学的一批） the number/group admitted to an institution

PARAGRAPH SEVEN

“I **think** you **should go**,” **said** Naomi.

PARAGRAPH EIGHT

Akira **was waiting** in the entry.



WORDS



★ **Entry [n.]**: the entrance area of a building/house 入口；门厅；玄关（进门的地方）

He **was** in his early twenties, slim and serious, wearing the black military-style uniform of a student.



WORDS



★ **slim [adj.]**: thin in an attractive or neat way (身材) 苗条的；清瘦的（多为褒义/中性） | small in amount; not very likely (可能性/资源) 微小的；不足的（常见搭配）

As he **bowed**—his hands hanging straight down, a black cap in one, a yellow oil-paper umbrella in the other—[时间状语从句]

Chie **glanced** beyond him.

WORDS

★ **bow** [v.]: 鞠躬；点头致意（表示礼貌、尊敬、道歉或感谢）to bend your head or upper body forward as a sign of respect, politeness, apology, or thanks.

★ **glance** [v.]: to look quickly 瞥一眼；迅速看一下



gaze → 长时间、专注地凝视（常带欣赏/沉思/情感）

glance → 快速、短暂的一瞥（中性，常是“扫一眼”）

stare → 直勾勾盯着看（强度大；常显得无礼/震惊/呆住）

peep → 偷偷看/窥视（动作小、带隐秘感；英式更常见）有时带不礼貌/让人不舒服的色彩（窥探隐私）

peer → “眯着眼/费力看清”（看不清才 peer）

peek → 偷偷/快速地看一眼；瞄一眼（常带“短暂、试探”）



In the glistening surface of the courtyard's rain-drenched paving stones, she **saw** his reflection like a dark double.



WORDS



★ **glistening** [adj.]: shining with a wet or glossy brightness 闪闪发光的；闪耀的（多因潮湿/光照而发亮）

★ **drenched** [adj.]: completely wet; soaked. 湿透的；浸湿的

★ **paving stone** [n.]: a flat stone used to cover a path or street 铺路石；人行道石板

★ **reflection** [n.]: an image seen in a mirror/water/surface; 倒影；映像；（光/声/热的）反射；also careful thought 反思



reflection: 倒影/映像（由镜面/水面等反射形成，常能看到一些细节）

shadow: 影子/阴影（被光照射时遮挡形成，多是黑色轮廓）



I raise my cup to invite the moon.

With my shadow, we become three.

举杯邀明月，对影成三人。（许渊冲译）



PARAGRAPH NINE

"Madame," **said** Akira, "**forgive** my disruption, but I **come** with a matter of urgency."



WORDS



★ **disruption** [n.]: an interruption of someone's peace, routine, or private time 打扰；干扰；造成不便

★ **urgency** [n.]: It is the pressure of time + importance: the situation cannot wait and demands immediate attention 紧急

PARAGRAPH TEN

His voice **was** soft, refined.



WORDS



★ **refined** [adj.]: polite and elegant; having good taste and good manners (人/举止/品味/声音) 文雅的；有教养的；优雅克制的 | purified or processed (物质/材料) 精炼的；提纯的；加工过的

He **straightened** and **stole** a deferential peek at her face.



WORDS



★ **straighten** [v.]: to make or become straight; to stand upright; to correct or tidy
弄直；伸直；（人）挺直身子；整理/纠正

★ **steal** [v.]: to do something quietly/secretly without being noticed 悄悄地做（某事）

★ **deferential** [adj.]: showing respect and politeness, especially to someone of higher status
恭敬的；表示尊重的；（对权威/长辈）谦恭顺从的

★ **peek** [v.]: a quick, often secret look 偷偷看/快速看一眼

PARAGRAPH ELEVEN

Chie **felt** herself starting to like him.

PARAGRAPH TWELVE

“**Come** inside, **get out of** this nasty night. Surely your business **can wait** for a moment or two.”



WORDS



★ **nasty** [adj.]: unpleasant in a strong, often physical or emotional way; it can suggest harsh, dirty, cruel, or difficult 强烈的“不舒服/讨厌/糟心”，有时带“恶劣、让人反感”的味道。

PARAGRAPH THIRTEEN

"I **don't want** to trouble you. Normally I **would approach** you more properly but **I've received** word of a position. **I've** an opportunity to go to America, as dentist for Seattle's Japanese community."

WORDS

★ **receive word:** to be informed; to get news (often formal/literary) 收到消息 / 通知; 得到口信 (常带“消息传来”的书面感)



hear (that...): 听说 (信息来源不一定正式)

be informed (that...): 被告知 (更正式)

get news / receive news: 得到消息 (中性)

learn (that...): 得知 (偏“后来才知道”)

★ **Seattle [n.]:** 西雅图, 美国华盛顿州 (Washington State) 最大城市。



PARAGRAPH FOURTEEN

"Congratulations," Chie **said** with **amusement**.

WORDS

★ **amusement [n.]**: a feeling of being entertained or finding something funny. 被逗乐; 好笑; 笑意 (情绪) | 娱乐; 消遣 (活动/事物)

"That **is** an opportunity, **I'm** sure. But how **am I involved?**"

PARAGRAPH FIFTEEN

Even noting Naomi's breathless reaction to the name card, Chie **had** no idea.



WORDS



★ **Note [v.]**: to notice; to observe. 注意到; 留意 | to write down 写下

Akira's message, delivered like a formal speech **filled** her with maternal amusement.



WORDS



★ **deliver** [v.]: to bring/give; to give a speech/message; to achieve; to help a baby be born. 递送; 发表/讲 (演讲、信息); 实现; 接生

★ **fill sb. with** : to make someone feel strongly (emotion) 使.....充满 (某种情绪/感觉)

★ **maternal** [adj.]: motherly; relating to a mother 母亲的; 母性的 (带保护、包容、怜爱的)

You **know**

how children **speak** so earnestly, so hurriedly, so endearingly about things that **have** no importance in an adult's mind?



WORDS



★ **earnestly** [adv.]: sincerely and seriously. 认真地; 诚恳地; 郑重地

★ **hurriedly** [adv.]: in a rush; quickly because of urgency 匆忙地; 急急忙忙地

★ **endearingly** [adv.]: in a lovable/charming way. 讨人喜欢地; 惹人怜爱地

PARAGRAPH SIXTEEN

That's

how she viewed him, as a child.

Even though Naomi **was** eighteen and **training** endlessly in the arts needed to make a good marriage, [让步状语从句]

Chie **had made** no effort to find her a husband.



尽管直美已经十八岁，并且在为“嫁得好”所需的种种技艺上不停训练，千惠却并没有费心替她物色丈夫。

PARAGRAPH SEVENTEEN

Akira **blushed**.



WORDS



★ **blush [v.]**: To blush means to become pink or red in the face because of an inner emotion, especially shyness, embarrassment, modesty, guilt, or being flattered. It often feels involuntary and can suggest a person is sensitive or self-conscious. 因为情绪而脸红，常见于 shy / embarrassed / ashamed / flattered

⚠ **flush**
To flush means to suddenly turn red in the face or skin, often because of heat, exercise, alcohol, fever, or strong emotions like anger or excitement. It tends to sound stronger and more physical than blush. 脸、皮肤突然发红，常由生理或强烈情绪触发（热、运动、酒精、发烧、愤怒、激动）

PARAGRAPH EIGHTEEN

“Depending on your response, I **may stay** in Japan. I **’ve come** to ask for Naomi’s hand.”



WORDS



★ **ask for sb's hand:** a traditional, formal expression meaning to request permission to marry that person, often said to the person's parents or guardian. It sounds polite and old-fashioned, and it fits a respectful, formal context.

PARAGRAPH NINETEEN



Suddenly Chie **felt** the dampness of the night.



WORDS



★ **dampness [n.]:** a slight but noticeable wetness in the air or on surfaces, often making the surroundings feel cool, clammy, and uncomfortable. It is not “soaking wet,” but moist enough to be felt 潮湿

PARAGRAPH TWENTY



“Does Naomi **know** anything of your...**ambitions**”

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-ONE



We **have** an understanding.

Please **don't judge** my candidacy by the unseemliness of this proposal.



WORDS



★ **candidacy** [n.]: the fact of being a candidate for a position; qualifications as a candidate 候选资格/参选身份（此处引申为“我作为求婚者/人选的资格”）

★ **unseemliness** [n.]: something that feels improper, awkward, or not socially appropriate. 无礼/唐突



恳请您莫因这次提亲略显失礼，而轻贬我追求良缘的真心。

I **ask** directly because the use of a go-between **takes** much time.

Either method **comes down to** the same thing: a matter of parental approval.



WORDS



★ **come down to**: to be essentially about, or to depend on one key factor after everything is considered. It often introduces the real core behind different choices 归结为

★ **approval** [n.]: agreement or official permission 赞同；认可；批准

If you **give** your consent, I **become** Naomi's yoshi.



WORDS



★ **consent** [n.]: a clear permission / agreement (often formal, legal, or authoritative) 许可/同意 (正式)



approval → 强调“赞许、认可”，可能带感情色彩。

consent → 强调“许可、允许”，尤其在 法律/正式场合，带有权权威性。（正式，自愿，常见于法律、医学、父母许可等场景）

★ **yoshi** [n.]: 日语婿/義子的用法 → “入赘的丈夫、女婿”。

We'll **live** in the House of Fuji.

Without your consent, I **must go** to America, to secure a new home for my bride.



WORDS



★ **Secure** [v.]: to obtain or arrange something important through effort, especially something that provides stability or safety 获得；取得 (= obtain, get, 往往费了一番努力)

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-TWO

Eager to make his point, he'd **been looking** her full in the face.



WORDS



★ **make one's point:** to express your idea clearly and successfully, so that others understand (and possibly accept) it 清楚地表达自己的观点；证明自己说得对

★ **look sb full in the face :** to look directly at someone's face, without avoiding eye contact—often showing seriousness, honesty, or determination 直视某人，正眼看某人（带强调，通常表示认真或直接）



*Abruptly, his voice **turned** gentle.*



WORDS



★ **abruptly [adv.]:** suddenly and unexpectedly, often with a sense of a sharp change—as if the switch happens without warning. It can also suggest the change feels a bit jerky or awkward 突然地



*"I **see**
I've **startled** you."*



WORDS



★ **startle [v.]:** to surprise or shock someone suddenly.使惊吓；使吓了一跳



My humble apologies.



WORDS



★ **humble [adj.]**: showing respect by placing yourself in a lower, modest position; very polite and deferential. 不是单纯“谦虚”，而是表达一种自我压低、恭敬的姿态



*I'll **take** no more of your evening.*



*My address **is** on my card*



*If you **don't wish** to contact me, I'll **reapproach** you in two weeks' time.*



Until then, good night.

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-THREE



*He **bowed and left**.*



Taking her ease, with effortless grace, like a cat making off with a fish.



WORDS



★ **take one's ease** to relax and enjoy yourself; to rest comfortably and without hurry. 放松；舒舒服服地休息；从容自在地待着（常带“很会享受/很从容”的语感）

★ **cat making off with a fish:** to steal or take something and leave quickly; to run off with it 顺手拿走/偷偷带走；得手后迅速溜走（常带“鬼精、敏捷、得逞”的画面）



这里的比喻“like a cat making off with a fish”也更像是在刻画 Chie 的机敏、优雅、带点狡黠的掌控感——像猫得手后轻巧溜走

PART THREE

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-FOUR

"Mother?" Chie **heard** Naomi's low voice and **turned** from the door.

"He **has asked** you?"

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-FIVE

The sight of Naomi's clear eyes, her dark brows **gave** Chie strength.

Maybe his hopes **were** preposterous.



WORDS



★ **preposterous [adj.]**: so unreasonable or illogical that it is hard to take seriously. It often carries a tone of disbelief or mocking surprise(“That’s just too much / no way”) 离谱/简直可笑
[SYN]
absurd / ridiculous (最常用)
ludicrous (更书面、更强调滑稽)
outrageous (更强调“离谱到让人震惊/恼火”)

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-SIX

“Where **did** you **meet** such a fellow?

Imagine!

He **thinks**
he **can marry** the Fuji heir and **take** her to America all in
the snap of his fingers!”



WORDS



★ **heir [n.]**: a person who will legally receive money, property, or a title when someone dies 继承人；后嗣

★ **in the snap of one’s fingers** : very quickly and easily, as if requiring no effort. 一弹指间；转眼间；不费吹灰之力

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-SEVEN

Chie **waited for** Naomi’s ripe laughter.



WORDS



★ **ripe laughter:** a warm, rich, full-bodied laugh, with a literary tone 爽朗的笑声

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-EIGHT

Naomi **was** silent.

She **stood** a full half minute looking straight into Chie's eyes.

Finally, she **spoke**.

"I **met** him at my literary meeting."

PARAGRAPH TWENTY-NINE

Naomi **turned** to go back into the house, then **stopped**.

PARAGRAPH THIRTY

"Mother."

PARAGRAPH THIRTY-ONE

“Yes?”

PARAGRAPH THIRTY-TWO

“I *mean to* have him.”



WORDS



★ **mean to do [v.]:** to intend to do something—to plan it deliberately, not by accident 打算做

ENDING